

Instant Pot Tamales

Sunday, March 16, 2025 2:51 PM

INGREDIENTS:

2 1/2 - 3 pounds Certified Angus Beef ® boneless chuck roast, cut into 2-inch cubes
16 corn husks
3 teaspoons adobo seasoning
1 teaspoon canola oil
4 dried guajillo chilies, seeded, stems removed and torn apart
3 bay leaves
1 cinnamon stick
2 teaspoons coco powder
2 teaspoons coffee
2 teaspoons dried oregano
1 teaspoon garlic powder
1 teaspoon onion powder
1 cup beef stock
3 cups masa
2 teaspoons chili powder
1 1/2 teaspoons baking powder
2 teaspoons kosher salt
2 sticks butter or 1 cup shortening, room temperature
2 1/2 cups warm water
Salsa verde (optional)

Yields 16 tamales

Cook Mode

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1. In a stockpot or deep pan, soak cornhusks in warm water for at least 1 hour. Preheat Instant Pot on Sauté setting. Season chuck cubes with adobo seasoning, add canola oil to pot and sear beef, working in three batches; reserve to a clean plate.
2. Add chilies, bay leaf and cinnamon stick to toast one minute. Stir in coco powder, coffee, oregano, garlic powder, onion powder and beef stock. Bring to a boil.
3. Return beef to pot, close and lock lid. Set to Pressure Cook High for 40 minutes. Allow Instant Pot to naturally depressurize for 20 minutes.
4. While beef is cooking make masa mixture. In a small mixing bowl combine masa, chili powder, baking powder and salt. Add butter (or shortening) and mix with a wooden spoon or rubber spatula until butter is well incorporated into masa. Stir in warm water, cover with plastic wrap and set aside.
5. Remove bay leaves and cinnamon stick from pot. Shred beef with two forks and reserve to a pan. Mix in one cup of the braising liquid and set aside.
6. Drain cornhusks and pat dry. Spread about 1/4-cup masa mixture starting from the wide end of the husk towards the narrow end creating a rectangle roughly 4 1/2-inches long from wide end to narrow end of husk and about 4 inches wide. There should be at least a 1-inch border of exposed cornhusk on the sides and about 3-inches from the narrow tip. Spoon a scant three tablespoons of the beef filling in a line down the center of the dough from wide end to narrow end. Fold long sides of cornhusk around filling then fold the narrow end toward the open end. Repeat with remaining husks.
7. Insert the steam tray in the bottom of the Instant Pot and add enough water to just barely touch the bottom of the tray without submerging in water.
8. Stand tamales in Instant Pot on folded end, mostly vertically. Close lid and Pressure Cook on High for 15 minutes. Allow to naturally depressurize for 20 minutes.
9. Remove from pressure cooker and cool for at least 10 minutes. Serve with salsa verde or your favorite salsa.

RECIPE 2

INGREDIENTS

MAKES 2 dozens

26 corn husks
1 lb Chuck roast(I use it to get fat on my broth)
2 lbs Chuck tender roast
Salt I used 3 tbsp
1/2 onion
5 garlic cloves
3 bay leaves
Water up to max line

For the sauce:

10 New Mexico Chile pods
2 Chile ancho
7 small tomatillos
Chile de arbol(optional)
4 garlic cloves
1 tsp ground cumin
1 tsp oregano
Salt to taste I added 2 1/2 tsp

For the masa

4 cups instant corn masa for tamales
8 oz lard
2 tsp baking powder
Salt to taste I added 1 tsp
4 cups broth
1 cup water
1 serving of love



BEEF

- Season beef with adobo and add onion chili garlic bay leaf to instant pot

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- Cook for 1.5 hour on meat stew setting
- Remove beef set aside and shred
- Strain 4 cups of the broth and place back in the instant pot to simmer additional chili's tomatillo.
- Remove chili's et al from instant pot and put into a blender/food processor add 1.5 cups of the broth as well as cumin oregano salt and pepper and blend until smooth
- Remove remaining broth from the instant pot clean and set to sauté.
- Lightly oil the instant pot and add the blended sauce
NOTE: you can add broth to blender/food processor to get the rest of the sauce out.
- Let sauce simmer for about 5 minutes then add beef back to it
- Simmer for 5 minutes more.

MASA

- Soften lard in the stand mixer for 5 min or so
- Add salt and baking powder and 1 cup of masa and 1 cup of the remaining broth
- Mix together
- Add another cup of masa and broth
- Mix together
- Add another cup of masa, broth
- Mix together
- Add last cup of masa, broth, and water
- Mix together on high for 12 to 15 minutes
NOTE: Test the masa by putting a piece in water and if it floats it's ready

PREP

- Prep tamales like traditional tamales with masa on corn husk with beef in the middle and roll and create fold at the end.
- Place a rack at the bottom of the instant pot cover it with a couple of corn husks
- Place your tamales in the instant pot facing up with the fold side down
- Use pressure cook setting on high for 45 minutes then allow to slow release for 15 minutes then fully release.
- Remove the lid and lift out the metal insert and allow to cool down for 15 minutes.

SERVE